

Someone much more philosophical than me once described parenting as ‘the art of letting go’.

Yeah . . . nah.

I think it’s more like running a 20-year marathon, with no directions, and a kid attached to your hip, screaming.

The truth is that once you get through the Barefoot Ten—whether that takes you 10 weeks or 20 years—you will have done more than what 99 per cent of parents do to prepare their kids for a rapidly changing world.

And that is an amazing achievement—one that you should be genuinely proud of.

So when you tick off the last Barefoot Ten, don’t wait around for a parade.

I want you to have your very own Victory Dinner . . . and leave the kids at home!



THE VICTORY DINNER



It’s time to raid your Smile account and go somewhere posh. You’re going to blow the doors off it. If you’re a single parent, take along someone who’s helped you through the tough times. Whatever your situation, this is your Victory Dinner—and you’ve earned this night a hundred times over.

I’m going to dispense with the entree, main and dessert, and go straight to the booze.

Please charge your glasses:

- You’ve showed your kids the joy of hard work, and they’ve volunteered in their local community. These two experiences have shown them what true success looks like. In a world of spiralling depression, victim blaming and middle-aged flogs on Facebook, your kids will have perspective. And they learned it from you.